

to have a very hard time later on. After you've completed the tutorial, you'll end up in a starting area called Limgrave. Here you can experiment with different builds and combat tactics. Just make sure you avoid the giant Tree Sentinel unless you're a masochist. Limgrave is huge and contains a bunch of catacombs, castles and swamp areas to give new players a glimpse of what's to come. The environments look beautiful, detailed and sometimes just plain terrifying (Caelid, anyone?). You've also got a horse named Torrent to help you traverse this large and dangerous world.

Story

In terms of a story, Elden Ring is the most straightforward of all the SoulsBorne games. You're thrust into a broken world as a tarnished and must fight through a bunch of demigods and monsters to claim the title of Elden Lord. The story is told through various NPCs and is never expositional. You're just a small part of this world and Elden Ring never lets you forget that. You should read all the item descriptions and pay attention to environmental storytelling. You could actually miss a lot of cool and interesting side-content if you just barrel your way through the game. Elden Ring is all about the journey and not the destination.

Combat

Combat has been given a new coat of paint with an insane amount of combinations you can walk into battle with. Want to play as a barbarian who cleaves his/her way through the opposition? Sink your runes (the in-game currency) into strength. If you're more of a spellcaster, you can play in that style as well. The combat is so malleable and presents you with so many options that every player will tackle different situations with different tools and strategies. There are some spells that completely break the game but you'll have to find those for yourself. Personally, I played as a



MOAR!

DEVELOPER

From Software

PUBLISHER

Bandai Namco

PLATFORM

Xbox One, Xbox Series

X/S, PS4, PS5, PC

PRICE

₹2,499 (Steam)

We played a purchased copy of Elden Ring on Steam.

straight-up barbarian and sunk all my runes into strength and endurance. I used the Bloodblade and Ghiza's Wheel as my main weapons along with a decent shield for defence. The game also gives you the option of going all out and having a weapon in both hands. It's a very glass-cannon approach but one that actually has some merit.

You can even summon spirits of enemies you've felled to help aid you in battle. I can't tell you how many times I scraped by a tough boss fight only because my summoned spirits distracted the boss, allowing me to deliver a few critical hits. The bottom line is that the game is incredibly flexible in the tools it gives you to complete your mission. If you're still having problems despite all these options, you should stick to games like Horizon Forbidden West and The Last of Us. Elden Ring was not made for you.

The open-world itself is massive with an insane amount of things to do. Again, this isn't your typical AAA game where the map is lit-

tered with markers etc. You slowly unlock the map by finding map fragments and the way From Soft decided to reveal the entire map is ingenious. You really have no idea how big the game world is even if you've completed three to four areas. It truly is a smart and engaging way to keep players exploring.

I haven't jumped into the PvP world as yet so I can't comment on that part of the game.

Verdict

I can't recommend Elden Ring enough. The game is a true masterpiece and deserves to be experienced by anyone who likes a bit of a challenge and not a Sony exclusive walking simulator. If you have to choose between Elden Ring and Horizon Forbidden West, I'd suggest you spend your money on the game that was made for fans and not a generic agenda-driven progressive darling that is barely a game and more of a boring tech demo. *